Forest and Wildlife

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Introduction:

Natural vegetation means plants that grow on their own without human help. In India, the types of natural vegetation vary because of differences in climate, soil, and land features:

1. **Climate**: India has many kinds of weather. Areas with a lot of rain, like the Western Ghats and Northeast India, have thick forests. Dry places like Rajasthan have few plants that can survive with little water.
2. **Soil**: Soil types affect what plants grow. Rich alluvial soil in the Gangetic plains helps many plants grow. Sandy soil in deserts supports only a few tough plants.
3. **Topography (Land Features)**: The shape and height of land also matter. Mountains like the Himalayas and Western Ghats have different kinds of forests due to changes in height and weather. Plains and coastal areas have different types of plants.

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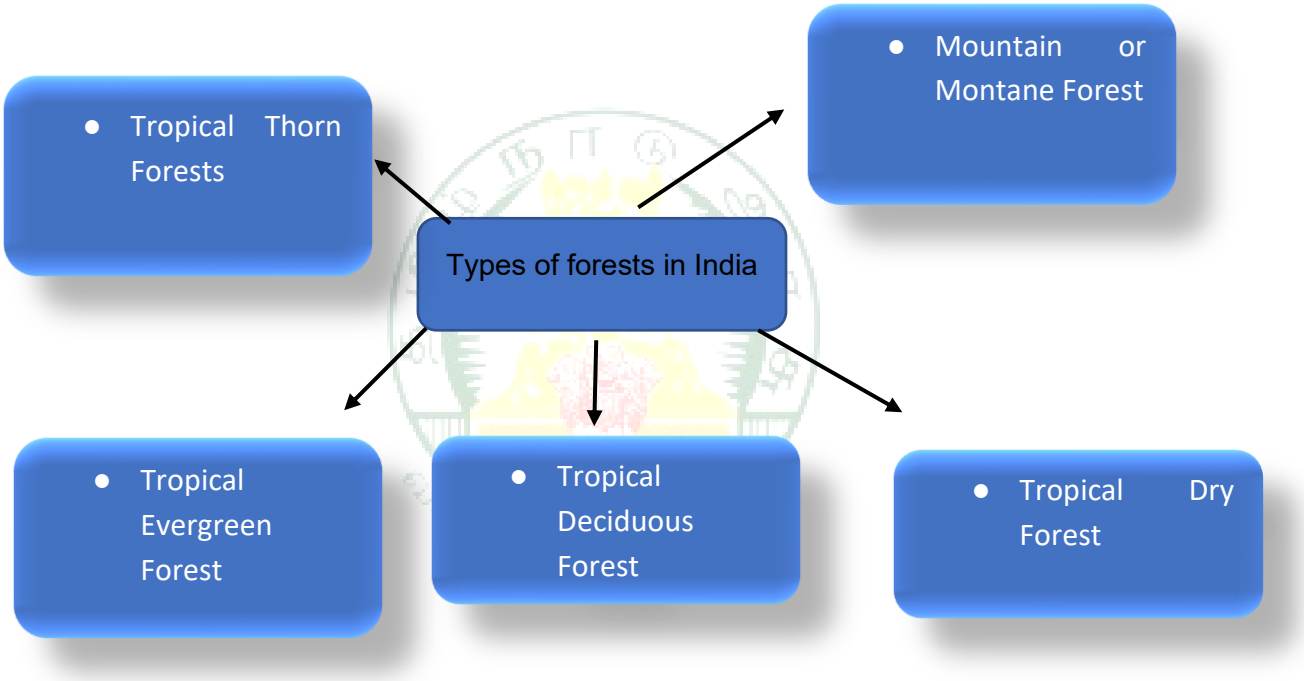
Director,

Department of Employment and Training.

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Green Cover in India

- Total Forest & Tree cover – 8,02,088 sq. k.m – (24.39%)
- Total Forest cover – 7,08,273 sq.km
  Tree cover – 93,815 sq km



Tropical Evergreen Forest

- Annual Rainfall is 200 cm or more
- Annual average Temperature is 22˚C more
- Humidity exceeds 70%
- Growing Trees are Rubber, Ebony, Rosewood, Coconut, Bamboo, Cinchona, Cedar

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Tropical Deciduous Forest

- Annual Rainfall - 100 to 200 cm
- Annual average Temperature - 27˚C
- Humidity - 60 to 70 %
- Monsoon Forests
- Growing trees are Teak, Sal

Tropical Dry Forest

- Annual Rainfall - 50 to 100 cm
- Growing trees are Mahua, Banyan, Amaltas, Palas, Haldu, Bamboo, Babool

Semi-desert Vegetation

- Tropical Thorn Forests
- Annual Rainfall is less than 50 cm
- Low Humidity & High Temperature
- Growing Trees – Babool, Kikar, wild palms

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Mountain Forest

Eastern Himalayan forest

- Annual Rainfall more than 200 cm
- Height - 1200-2400 m
- Growing trees are Sal, Oak, Laurel, Amura, Chestnut
- Oak, birch, silver, fir, fine, spruce and juniper are the major trees found at the altitude of 2400 to 3600m

Western Himalayan Forest

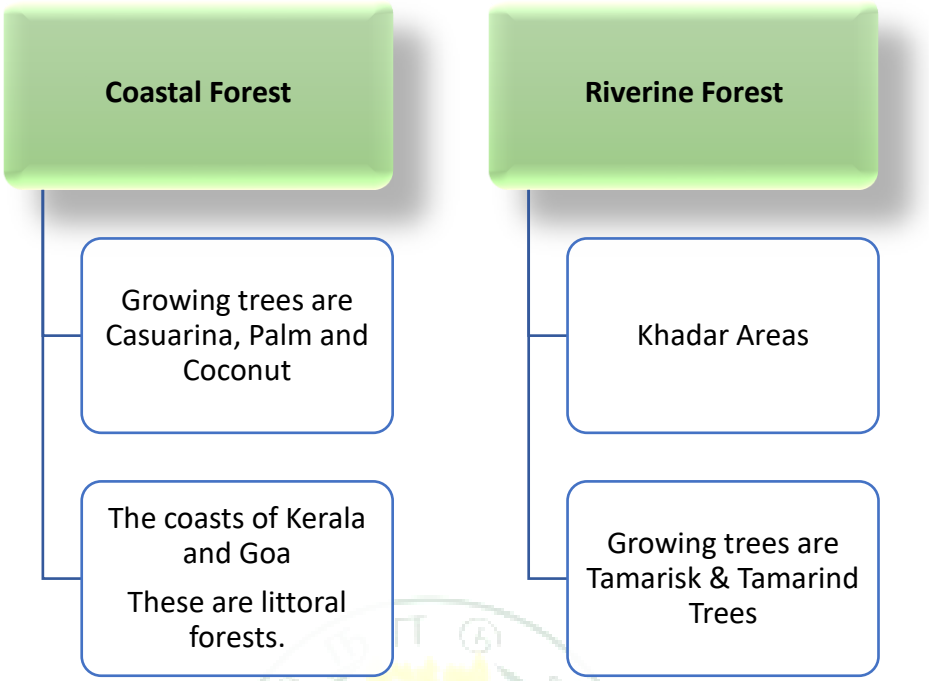
- Upto 900 m - semi desert vegetation
- 900 - 1800 m – chir tree
- 1800 - 3000 m – semi temperate coniferous forests
- The other important trees of this region are sal, semal, dhak, jamun and jujube

Alpine Forest

- It occurs all along the Himalayas with above 2400 m altitude. These are purely coniferous trees.
- The Eastern parts of the Himalayas have a large extent of these forests.
- Growing trees are Oak, Silver, Fir, Pine, Juniper

Tidal Forest

- Delta or Swamp forests
- Deltas, Estuaries and Creeks prone
- Delta of the Ganga-Brahmaputra



Wildlife

India has a rich and diversified wildlife. The Indian fauna consists of about 81,251 species of animals out of the world's total of about 1.5 million species.

Species	81,251
Invertebrates	6500
Molluscs	5000
Fishes	2546
Birds	1228
Mammals	458
Reptiles	446
Amphibians	204
Panthers	4
Insects	60,000

The Indian Board for Wildlife (IBWL)

It was constituted in 1952 to suggest means of protection, conservation and management of wildlife to the government

The Government of India enacted the Wildlife (Protection) Act in 1972 with the objective of effectively protecting the wildlife of the country and to control poaching, smuggling and illegal trade in wildlife and its diversities

To preserve the country's rich and diverse wildlife a network of 102 National Parks and about 515 Wildlife Sanctuaries across the country have been created.

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Biosphere Reserves in India

- Biosphere reserves are protected areas of land coastal environments
- The Indian government has established 18 Biosphere Reserves
- In India Project Tiger was launched in April 1973 with the aim to conserve tiger population in specifically constituted "Tiger Reserves" in India.
- Eleven of the eighteen biosphere reserves (Gulf of Mannar, Nandadevi, the Nilgiris, Nokrek, Pachmarhi, Simlipal, Sundarbans Agasthiyamalai, Great Nicobar, Kanjanjunga and Amarkantak) of India fall under the list of Man and Biosphere programme of UNESCO.

S.No.	Biosphere reserves	state
1	Achanakmar-Amarkantak	Madhya Pradesh, Chattisgarh
2	Agasthyamalai	Kerala
3	Dibru Saikhowa	Assam
4	Dihang Dibang	Arunachal Pradesh
5	Great Nicobar	Andaman and Nicobar Islands
6	Gulf of Mannar	Tamil nadu
7	Kachchh	Gujarat
8	Kanchenjunga	Sikkim
9	Manas	Assam
10	Nanda Devi	Uttarakhand

11	The Nilgiris	Tamil nadu
12	Nokrek	Meghalaya
13	Pachmarhi	Madhya Pradesh
14	Simlipal	Odisha
15	Sundarbans	West Bengal
16	Cold desert	Himachal Pradesh
17	Sesahachalam hills	Andhra Pradesh
18	Panna	Madhya Pradesh